



The Meaning of Words and Discourses

Before you decide to take part in this study you need to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish. A member of the team can be contacted if there is anything that is not clear or if you would like more information. Take time to decide whether or not you wish to take part.

Purpose of the study

This research aims to investigate the use of the English language in understanding discourses. The data collection will occur in December 2024, and the entire research project will be complete by the end of 2025.

Why have I been chosen?

This is a study performed on L1 English speakers who have lived in the UK for at least the last few years, completed on Prolific. If you have been selected to participate in this study, it is because you meet these requirements.

Do I have to take part?

Taking part is entirely voluntary and refusal or withdrawal will involve no penalty or loss, now or in the future. If you do decide to take part, you may withdraw at any point for any reason before submitting your answers by pressing the 'Exit' button/ closing the browser. However, we are only able to reimburse participants who complete all research activities.

What will happen to me if I take part?

In this questionnaire, you will be asked questions on the meanings of different conversations and words. These questions will be open-ended. This should take about 15 minutes. No background knowledge is required. Participants will be paid for the completion of the questionnaire.

Are there possible disadvantages and/or risks in taking part?

Some dialogues that participants may be asked to read may contain references to certain sensitive topics, including the usage of swear words, discussions of political issues, discussions of medical issues, discussions of eating disorders, mentions of discrimination, and mentions of animal cruelty. As previously stated, participants may choose to stop their participation in the study at any time.



Will my taking part in this project be kept confidential?

The data will be used as part of a PhD project within Linguistics, and no third parties will be given access to the data. The data we will collect that could identify you will be your prolific ID, age range, and domain of occupation. Your IP address will not be stored. This information is required to see how answers vary across these social categories. All data will be identified only by a code, with personal details kept in a locked file or secure computer with access only by the immediate research team. The responses you provide will be stored in a password-protected electronic file on the University of Cambridge secure servers and may be used in PhD theses, articles, conference presentations, and other academic purposes. Identifiable information will be deleted as soon as it is no longer required.

How long will my data be retained?

In line with University policy, data will generally be kept till the completion of the project + 10 years. Anonymised data will be deposited to the Apollo---University of Cambridge Repository, <https://www.repository.cam.ac.uk/>, for future research and study.

What will happen to the results of the research project?

Results will be primarily published within a PhD thesis but may also be presented at conferences and written up in journals. Results are normally presented in terms of groups of individuals. If any individual data are presented, the data will be completely anonymous, without any means of identifying the individuals involved.

Ethical review of the study

The project has received ethical approval from the Research Ethics Committee of the Faculty of Modern and Medieval Languages & Linguistics at the University of Cambridge.

Contact for further information

If you have a concern about any aspect of this research, please contact Nina Haket (nch35@cam.ac.uk) and we will do our best to answer your query. We will acknowledge your concern within 10 working days and give you an indication of how it will be dealt with.